

MANDATORY FIRST SESSION (MASS MEETING)!

AM Section 001: Monday, August 25, at 9:00 AM in Weiser Hall in the 10th floor meeting room.

PM Section 002: Monday, August 25, at 1:00 PM in Weiser Hall in the 10th floor meeting room.

Welcome!

The Program on Intergroup Relations
1214 S. University Ave, 2nd Floor, Suite B
Phone: 734-936-1875; www.igr.umich.edu

Instructors: AM Section 001

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PM Section 002

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**** You will be assigned two co-facilitators who will share their contact information with you. *****

Office Hours:

If you would like to meet with your instructors, please email us and we will gladly meet with you via zoom or in person. If you would like to meet with your peer facilitators, they will let you know about their office hours.

Welcome! We are so glad you have signed up for our unique dialogue course. Your dialogue section will be facilitated by two students who have been trained by The Program on Intergroup Relations. Your peer facilitators have taken an entire course on intergroup dialogue facilitation and are specifically prepared for facilitating your section. If at any time you have any questions or concerns about the course that are not answerable by your peer facilitators, please email the instructors of the course at the email above. *Please allow at least 48 hours for email responses, and note that we generally do not respond to emails on weekends.*

This course fulfills a requirement for the [Intergroup Relations Education minor](#)! Please check out the IGR website for more information or email igrcourses@umich.edu to schedule an advising appointment about the minor!

Course Description:

In a multicultural society, we need carefully facilitated dialogues to help deepen our understanding across different racial/ethnic, gender, sexual orientation, social class, and other divides. In this intergroup (or intra-group) dialogue, students will participate in semi-structured face-to-face meetings across social

identity groups. Students will discuss relevant reading material and will participate in group activities that help shed light on various social and institutional contexts. Participants will examine narratives and historical, psychological, and sociological materials. Students will participate in exercises that will be debriefed in class and in weekly reflections. Students will learn about pertinent issues facing the participating groups on campus and in society. The goal is to create a setting in which students engage in open and constructive dialogue, learning, and exploration concerning issues of intergroup relations, conflict, and community.

Course Objectives:

- 1) Learn about intergroup dialogue as a distinct form of communication and develop dialogue skills.
- 2) Learn about your own and others social group identities, and multiple and intersectional identities.
- 3) Understand the influence of social identity on intergroup relations.
- 4) Understand how these social identities relate to individual, institutional, structural and cultural inequalities, and how they relate to power, privilege, and oppression.
- 5) Critically analyze contemporary issues related to social identity conflict.
- 6) Learn about working productively in diverse groups, building coalitions, and utilizing knowledge about identities, structures of inequality and dialogic communication to create social change.

PLACEMENTS, TEXTS, AND WEEKLY ASSIGNMENTS

Required Texts: Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues, (S. Hicks)

All readings will be made available on Canvas.

Dialogue Placement:

You will receive an email message regarding your dialogue topic, your facilitators' names, the location of your section **the week of September 1st**. All readings for the course are in the textbook, *Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues* or on Canvas. Facilitators will place any additional readings on Canvas.

POLICIES and PROCEDURES

Diversity Statement:

It is our intention that all students from all backgrounds and perspectives will be well served by this course and that the diversity that students bring to this class will be viewed as an asset. We welcome individuals of all ages, beliefs, genders, gender identities, gender expressions, national origins, religious affiliations, sexual orientations, socioeconomic backgrounds, family education level, ability – and other visible and nonvisible differences. All members of this class are expected to contribute to a respectful, welcoming and inclusive environment for every other member of this class. Your suggestions are encouraged and appreciated.

Accessibility & Accommodations:

If you need accommodation for a disability, please let us know at your earliest convenience. Some aspects of this course, such as the assignments, activities, or the way we teach may be modified to

facilitate your participation and progress. As soon as you make us aware of your needs, we can work with you. Please also contact the Office of Services for Students with Disabilities (SSD) at G664 Haven Hall phone: 734-763-3000, or the [Adaptive Technologies Computing Site](#) to help determine appropriate accommodations. Once your eligibility for an accommodation has been determined you will be issued a verified individual services accommodation (VISA) form. Please present this form to your instructors at the beginning of the term, or at least two weeks prior to the need for the accommodation (test, project, etc...). We will treat any information about your disability with the utmost discretion.

Student Health, Wellbeing, and Support :

The University of Michigan is committed to advancing the health and wellbeing of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of other support, please know that the following resources are available at no cost to students:

Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) - 734-764-8312 | caps.umich.edu

Sexual Assault Prevention & Awareness Center (SAPAC) - 734-936-3333 | sapac.umich.edu

University Health Service (UHS) - 734-764-8320 | uhs.umich.edu

Dean of Students (DOS) - 734-764-7420 | deanofstudents.umich.edu

Student Legal Services - 734-763-9920 | studentlegalservices.umich.edu

Maize & Blue Cupboard - 734-936-2794 | mbc.studentlife.umich.edu

Student Emergency Funding - provost.umich.edu/studentemergencyfunds.html

[IGR Resource List](#) (List of variety of campus resources for students)

Surveys:

We rely upon your honest feedback to help us continue to improve. We look at every survey and make changes based upon your feedback. There are 3 surveys we ask you to take.

1. IGR online survey. IGR administers a survey of your learning experience at the end of this course. This survey is a brief on-line experience that is completely anonymous and voluntary. There are no risks involved in taking this survey. It is designed to help IGR understand your learning experience and helps us continue to develop our pedagogy. This is a brief survey that should take you less than 10 minutes, but provides extremely useful information for us.
2. Student Life Survey. You will be asked to complete the Student Life Outcomes Survey at the end of the semester
3. Course evaluation. You will be asked to evaluate the course and instructors at the end of the semester through the traditional UM Survey instrument.

Attendance Policy:

This course is designed to be collaborative, and in many ways depends on each of our active participation. That being said, attendance and participation are critical behaviors for our class and you should plan to be at all our classes if possible. **Three (3) absences of any kind (excused or unexcused) will result in not getting an A in the class. More than six (6) absences will result in receiving an incomplete, or a failing grade in the class. If you foresee attendance being an ongoing concern, please consult your facilitators as soon as possible to discuss options.**

Should an emergency arise (illness, accident, etc.) that prevents you from attending a class session, it is your responsibility to contact your facilitators BEFORE class if at all possible. Additionally, please be

prepared to provide documentation verifying the cause of your absence. Students may self-report illnesses or absences using the [LSA Illness or Absence Reporting Form](#). Please note that completing this form does not constitute an excused absence and additional documentation may still be requested. In the event we need to conduct a class session via Zoom, please be sure to check Canvas announcements and your email regularly.

People who have **religious or cultural observations** that conflict with class or assignments should notify their facilitators by **Monday, September 8th**. We **strongly** encourage you to honor your cultural and religious holidays. However, if we don't hear from you by then, we will assume that you plan to follow the schedule without change.

We follow the university policy regarding bereavement absences.

You must also show up on time and prepared with all materials for the class. Readings are expected to be completed on the day they are due.

Course Content Info:

Please note that there will be times where the class activities, readings and dialogues occurring throughout the year may cause some dissonance for you. There may be instances where you feel discomfort at the discrepancy between what you already know or believe to be true and new information that is introduced to you in this course. We should all be mindful, critical, and accountable for the consequences and impact that our experiences, statements and actions will have on others and ourselves. Maintaining a brave space is critical, and yet there will be important moments of conflict that are also essential. We believe that learning occurs in a variety of ways and that creating dissonance in an experiential setting is a valuable component of social justice education.

Names and Pronouns:

All students will be referred to by the names and pronouns they use (e.g., she, they, ze, he). If you have a name that differs from the one that appears on the roster, please inform the instructor before the second class period so that they use your correct name and pronouns. Students can designate their personal pronouns on the class roster via Wolverine Access: Student Business > Campus Personal Information > Gender Identity.

Course Recordings

Course lectures may be audio/video recorded and made available to other students in this course. As part of your participation in this course, you may be recorded. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact the instructor the first week of class to discuss alternative arrangements.

Students are prohibited from recording/distributing any class activity without written permission from the instructor, except as necessary as part of approved accommodations for students with disabilities. Any approved recordings may only be used for the student's own private use.

Additional information regarding course recordings and privacy concerns can be found on the [UM ITS Recording and Privacy Concerns webpage](#).

GRADES & ASSIGNMENTS

This is a 3-credit, letter-graded course. The final course grade will be based on the following requirements:

- Attendance and Participation (45% of your grade)
- Weekly Reflections and Readings (40%)
- Collaborative Project (15% of your grade)
 - Proposal (5 %)
 - Project itself (5%)
 - Reflection on Project Form (5%)

All letter grades will be determined according to this scale:

A	94-100	B+	87-89	C+	77-79	D+	67-69	No credit	<59
A-	90-93	B	84-86	C	74-76	D	64-66		
		B-	80-83	C-	70-73	D-	60-63		

Please note: As a Program, we do not give the grade "A+." The highest possible grade is "A." There is no curve.

Attendance and Participation (45%)

The success of this course rests largely on your informed, honest, and active involvement. Dialogue cannot occur without you. Therefore, you will earn points for attendance and participation using the following system:

- 2 points:** Arrives on time; participates in activities; contributes well to dialogue; makes effective use of dialogic skills (including listening skills); links comments to readings where appropriate, and otherwise genuinely contributes to dialogue with others.
- 1 point:** Present, participates in activities, but does not contribute very effectively to the larger dialogue.
- 0 points:** Absent, or is unengaged.

A few important notes:

1. **Late Arrivals:** Tardiness is disruptive to the co-facilitators and your fellow classmates. Although we understand that late arrival is occasionally unavoidable, we consider habitual lateness disrespectful to all members of the class. You must also show up on time and prepared with all materials for the class. If you are more than fifteen minutes late, that counts as one absence. Three tardies (late by less than 15 minutes) also counts as an absence.
2. Our goal is reflection and meaningful contribution. Participation in this course means adhering to community guidelines, paying attention to how much space you take up in a room, and listening to understand. **Participants support and help others participate. In other words, your participation grade is based not on the quantity of your input but the quality** (e.g., depth, consistency, evidence of critical thinking, listening generously, asking questions, etc.).
3. We realize that people contribute and learn in a variety of ways, and that different cultures have different norms about education. Thus, we work to provide different kinds of opportunities to

participate, engage, and reflect. **Please let your facilitator know if there is anything they can do to better support your participation!**

Reflections and Readings (40%)

Most weeks, you will be asked to complete a reflection assignment and submit it on Canvas. Your facilitators will grade this assignment out of 10 points. As a reminder, reflections comprise 40% of your overall grade. Your weekly reflection assignments will have two parts: a reading reflection and a personal reflection.

Part One: The Reading Reflection will ask you to find three quotes that spark your thinking, your curiosity, or a reaction of some kind. This part is worth 3 points.

Part Two: The Personal Reflection will ask you to write in a journal-style format about your observations, growth, and experiences in the class throughout the course. You'll see prompting questions to guide you. These reflections are expected to be around 1.5 pages (double-spaced, 12-point font) and are worth 7 points per week.

All assignments are described in detail on the Canvas page under "Assignments," including instructions about how to submit your work. Please note that while some assignments are ungraded, we expect that you complete all assignments; failing to do reflection assignments prior to class may impact your ability to participate fully in the course (and thus also affect your participation grade). If you have any questions or concerns, please reach out to your facilitators!

Personal Narrative Assignment: (Sept. 22, 2025 in class)

- One particular assignment—the personal narrative—is due in class in the fourth week. We encourage you to read the expectations ahead of time, as it may take more time to reflect and prepare than other assignments.
- This assignment goes toward your in-class participation grade.

Collaborative Project (15%) (Dec. 1, 2025 and Dec. 8, 2025) bring to dialogue

- This is a group assignment in which you are asked to work with a diverse team from your dialogue section to creatively present a comment, question, or demonstration of some topic you've talked about in class.
- Know that you'll begin to work on this halfway through the semester and you'll have support from your facilitators along the way!
- There are multiple stages to this project
- You will receive more details, including a rubric, about this project on Canvas

Connect with IGR on Social Media:



facebook.com/umigr



LinkedIn Group: UM Program on
Intergroup Relations



flickr.com/umigr



youtube.com/ProgramOnIGR

CLASS SCHEDULE

SESSION	DATE	CLASS TOPIC	ASSIGNMENTS DUE		
			All readings should be completed prior to class. Readings on Canvas unless otherwise noted.	Coursepack Reflection assignments are ungraded but important for class activities.	Canvas reflection assignments are graded and due at noon on Friday before your dialogue session unless indicated otherwise. Items marked red will have greater detail in Canvas.
1	8/25	Mass meeting AM Section 001 (9 am - 12)- Weiser Hall 10th Floor PM Section 002 (1-4 pm) - Weiser Hall 10th Floor • Orientation to IGR and Intergroup Dialogue (IGD) • Understand goals of the course and expectations of IGD • Introduction to course instructors & facilitators • Learn how IGD facilitators have developed and used their skills	No work due		
	9/1	LABOR DAY - NO CLASS	Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas Prior to Session 2		

2	9/8	YOUR FIRST MEETING WITH YOUR DIALOGUE GROUP (Check your email for your classroom location) Creating a Shared Meaning of Dialogue • Understand intergroup dialogue as distinct from other forms of communication • Concept of Brave Spaces and Community Agreements • Understand key concepts and processes in IGD process	BEFORE SESSION 2 Read 1. Chapters 1 & 2, pp. 1-8 in Hicks, S. (2020). <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i>. 2. bell hooks, <i>Teaching to Transgress</i>, Chapter 10 (on Canvas) Coursepack work (p. 10) This week we'll be talking about brave spaces. After you've finished the assigned reading (and before Session 2), spend a few minutes considering the following questions: What do you need in order to be honest in a small group? What helps you take little risks? Jot down your thoughts in the CP. We'll be discussing this more in class.
3	9/15	Group Membership and Multiple Identities • Understand the concept of social group identities and multiple identities • Group norms • Begin learning and practicing dialogue skills	BEFORE SESSION 3 1. Chapter 3 & 4 (pp 17-58) in Hicks, S. (2020). <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i> 2. Please see Canvas for any additional readings related to your dialogue's topic Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas prior to Session 3.
4	9/22	Personal Narratives • Share life experiences and connect them to intersectional and group social identity and social inequality, including racial/ethnic identity	BEFORE SESSION 4 Read 1. Hicks Chapter 5 (pp.59-60) 2. Past examples of personal narratives/testimonials 3. Please see Canvas for any dialogue-specific readings

		● Create a learning community and commitment to co-learning process	PERSONAL NARRATIVE ASSIGNMENT. Due in class (credit/no credit). After you've completed the readings, prepare a personal narrative to read aloud. As you think about your own identity related to this dialogue topic, what have you experienced? How does it inform how you see yourself? We'll take turns reading these aloud. (Please see Canvas for guiding questions & tips.)
5	9/29	Historical Moments in Racism/Sexism/Classism/Heterosexism ● Learn about historical event that you may not know about ● Consider the impact of historical events on your familial history ● Identify major themes that come up in history again and again ● Think about how we can move toward social justice Collaborative Project Groups are announced by facilitators	BEFORE SESSION 5 Read Selections from Chapter 7 (pp.85-149); your facilitator will tell you which parts to read. For RE, SoC & WRID, please read or watch one of the following: ● Ta-Nehisi Coates (2014), "The Case for Reparations" in <i>The Atlantic</i> ● Watch 13th or ● Michelle Alexander, <i>The New Jim Crow</i>, Chapter 1, p. 1-58 on Canvas For SES, please watch one of the following: ● "Poverty after the Pandemic" https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UF60TuzVjmc ● "Two American Families" https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7AAUcmyXbg4&t=2669s For Gender, please read or watch one of the following: ● "Disclosure" documentary (~100 min) ● Szorenyi, 2022 - "Judith Butler: their philosophy of gender explained" ● Waters - 2024 "At the Paris Olympics, Sex Testing Will Be in Full Force. How Did We Get Here?" ● The Origin of Gender - PBS (~10 min) For Sexuality, please watch: ● Stonewall Forever - A Documentary about the Past, Present and Future of Pride Coursepack work (p.29) Reflect on the prompts provided:

			• What do you know about your family's history (ex: how they came to the US, what jobs have they held, family legends, etc)? • What do you know about the history of the land on which your family abides? Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas.
6	10/6	Four Types of Oppression 1. Individual 2. Interpersonal 3. Institutional 4. Cultural • Understand the Four Levels of Oppression • Understand implicit bias and what we can do about it • Understand what Microaggressions are and how to respond • Understand how institutions are interconnected and work to privilege some and disadvantage others Collaborative Project Brainstorming in class	BEFORE SESSION 6 Read 1. Chapter 6 (pp.63-84) in Hicks, S. (2020) <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i> 2. Adams and Bell <i>Teaching for Diversity and Social Justice, Vol 3</i> Chapter 4: "Getting Started, Core Concepts for Social Justice Education" by Adams and Zúñiga, p. 97-105. 3. Watch 5 min Anderson Cooper video on implicit Bias 4. Watch 2 min NYT video on implicit bias Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas.
	10/13	FALL STUDY BREAK - NO CLASS	Enjoy your break

7	10/20	Privilege ● Explore your own privilege ● Explore group privilege ● Learn that we all have privileges ● Think about what we can do with our privilege(s)	BEFORE SESSION 7 Read 1. Your facilitators will recommendation <u>selections</u> of Chapter 8 in Hicks, S. (2020) <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i> 2. Allan Johnson, <i>Privilege, Oppression and Difference</i>, Ch. 2, (p. 12-40) 3. Optional/Recommended for R+E & WRID: Peggy McIntosh, White Privilege: Unpacking the Invisible Knapsack Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas. Additional work on Canvas: - Fill out google form for caucus groups. - Fill out google form for contemporary conflicts (weeks 9-11). Collaborative Project Proposal Drafts Due for Peer Review in Class (One Per Group)
8	10/27	Identity, Social Relations, and Conflict (Exploring identities through intersections and intersectionality) ● Explore dynamics of intergroup relations in the classroom ● Explore membership in own social identity group in the dialogue ● Understand individual and intra-group identity	BEFORE SESSION 8 Read 1. More selections from Chapter 7 and Chapter 8 in Hicks, S. (2020) <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i>, as directed by your facilitators 2. Crenshaw, The Urgency of Intersectionality Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas. AFTER SESSION 8 Submit Revised Collaborative Project Proposal

		● Reflect on identity continuum and intersectionality with identities. ● Identify similarities and differences within and across social identity groups ● Active listening and perspective-taking skills	
9	11/3	Identity, Social Relations, and Conflict (Exploring identities through Caucus Groups) ● Explore dynamics of intergroup relations in the classroom ● Explore membership in own social identity group in the dialogue ● Understand individual and intra-group identity ● Learn how to stay in dialogue even when groups differ ● Learn how to use conflict to deepen understanding	BEFORE SESSION 9 Read 1. More selections from Chapter 7 and Chapter 8 in Hicks, S. (2020) <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i>, as directed by your facilitators 2. Your facilitators will assign specific readings for this session; please watch for a Canvas announcement or an email from your facilitators. Reach out to your facilitators if you can not find/access this week's readings. No reflection due; work on your collaborative project!
10	11/10	Issues of Social Justice: Exploring Current Conflicts Productively: Linking the interpersonal, Structural, Institutional, & Cultural ● Address unresolved issues or another Current Conflict ● Reflection	BEFORE SESSION 10 Read 1. Chapter 9 (p. 215-219) in Hicks, S. (2020) <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i> 2. Please see Canvas/email for your dialogue topic's readings (RE, SES, SOC, Sex Or, or WRID) Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas.

			AFTER SESSION 10 Complete google form/poll about how your collaborative project is progressing thus far. Please submit one per person.
11	11/17	Issues of Social Justice: Exploring Current Conflicts Productively: Linking the interpersonal, Structural, Institutional, & Cultural - Address unresolved issues or another Current Conflict - Reflection Check-ins with facilitators about Collaborative Projects in Class	BEFORE SESSION 11 Read - Paulo Freire, <i>Pedagogy of the Oppressed</i>, Chapter 2. - Please see Canvas/email for your dialogue topic's readings (RE, SES, SOC or WRID) No reflection due; work on your collaborative project!
12	11/24	Allyhood, Accomplices & Coalition Building - Defining terms and exploring how they apply to one's social justice journey - Cycle of Liberation (follow up to Cycle of Socialization)	BEFORE SESSION 12 - Chapters 10 & 11 (p. 221-275) in Hicks, S. (2020) <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i> - Watch "Ally, Accomplice & Co-conspirator" - clip from Brittany Packnett interview (2019) Available on Canvas and here: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QZVILjJPreM (5 min) - Ahmed- "The Culture of Campus Social Justice Elitism" - Please see Canvas for your dialogue topic's readings. Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas. Continue to work on your collaborative project—it's due next week!

13	12/1	Presenting Our Collaborative Projects ● Half of class will present projects ● Continued conversation about allyhood, accomplices & coalition building	
14	12/8	Presenting Our Collaborative Projects ● Remaining groups will present their projects Endings & Beginnings ● Next steps & action planning ● Affirmations & Appreciations ● Wrap up!	BEFORE SESSION 14 Review Chapters 10 & 11 (p. 221-275) in Hicks, S. (2020) <i>Introduction to Intergroup Dialogues</i> – we will be revisiting this! Reflection Assignment Please complete the Reflection Assignment on Canvas.

